Grigorii Sobol

Senior Software Engineer Compilers · Distributed runtimes · Cryptography

- **Email:** grishasobolo@gmail.com *(preferred means of communication)*
- **GitHub:** https://github.com/grishasobol
- **LinkedIn:** https://www.linkedin.com/in/gsobol/
- **Location:** Belgrade, Serbia · Citizenship: Russia
- **Open to:** remote and relocation in EU / UK / US · ready for business trips

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Summary

Team lead of Vara.eth at Gear Technologies — an Ethereum-anchored L1 rollup I build in Rust, from the consensus layer down to the WASM runtime. 10+ years on performance-critical systems where compilers, distributed runtimes, and cryptography meet, with a strong low-level background — LLVM, binary translators, and toolchains at Intel, NVIDIA, Huawei, and MIPT. What I do best: invent algorithms, design solutions, and carry them all the way to a finished, production-ready implementation — increasingly in close collaboration with AI coding tools (Claude Code, Codex).

Work experience

Senior Software Engineer — Gear Technologies

September 2021 — present Remote (gear-tech.io) · Blockchain / L1 protocol development

- Team lead of **Vara.eth** since January 2026; architect of the protocol — an Ethereum-anchored rollup with its own block-producer, announces protocol, signer, and BFT consensus on Malachite.
- Core developer of the **Vara Network** L1 (Substrate-style runtime).
- WebAssembly sandboxing and JIT internals — Wasmer, Wasmi, dlmalloc.
- Applied cryptography — secp256k1, FROST threshold signatures, DLEQ proofs.
- Design algorithms and solutions and take them end-to-end to merged, production code.
- **Work examples:**

- dlmalloc port for gear WASM programs — https://github.com/gear-tech/dlmalloc-rust
- Malachite BFT for Vara.eth - https://github.com/gear-tech/gear/pull/5419
- Lazy memory accesses - https://github.com/gear-tech/gear/pull/639

Lead Software Engineer — Huawei Technologies
August 2019 — September 2021 Moscow · Telecommunications / Mobile Communications

- Developed new optimizations for a Linux-based universal binary translator, improving target-code performance by ~50%.
- Improved translator stability and built performance-testing tooling for its runtime environments.

Engineer / Programmer — NVIDIA (Russian Branch)
August 2018 — August 2019 · Moscow

Designed and implemented a new compilation phase for a binary translator.

Senior / Junior Software Engineer — Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology
September 2016 — July 2018 · Laboratory of Complex Organizational and Technological Systems (SLOTS)

Built an LLVM-based back-end compiler and a simulator for a digital signal processor (C++), plus the test infrastructure and build system (Python 2/3, Bash, CMake).

Trainee Programmer — Intel Corporation
August 2015 — August 2016 · Moscow

Compiler-team development for the Intel Compiler (C++); system-administration automation (Bash, Python).

Skills

Languages & compilers · Rust · C/C++ · Python · Bash · Assembler · LLVM · GDB · compilers & binary translators

Blockchain & cryptography · Ethereum · Web3 · Solidity · WASM · secp256k1 / FROST / DLEQ · ZK

Systems & tooling · Linux · ARM · Git · GitHub · CMake · AI coding tools (Claude Code, Codex)

Strengths · algorithm & solution design · end-to-end ownership · AI-assisted development · code review · technical writing

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Education

Master's degree — 2019 Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology (MIPT) Faculty of Radio Engineering and Computer Technologies (FRKT) — Applied Mathematics and Physics

Bachelor’s degree — 2016 Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology (MIPT) Faculty of Radio Engineering and Cybernetics (FRTK) — Applied Mathematics and Physics

Languages

- Russian — Native
- English — C1, Advanced

About me

Where I’d like to go next: the compute infrastructure underneath AI. I’m less drawn to building the models themselves than to the systems they run on — making large-scale, compute-hungry AI workloads faster and more efficient through performance engineering, runtimes, and compilers.

Off-hours: piano, sport, travel. Driver’s license category B.